



EER98
London
£75,000
Immediately Available

CIMA qualified education finance leader with a proven track record across single academies, multi-academy trusts and trust transformation programmes. Extensive expertise in financial strategy, governance, audit, budget management and trust-wide operational leadership. Successfully delivered MAT formation, financial recovery plans, finance system implementations and operational improvements while maintaining full compliance with Academy Trust Handbook requirements.

EER98

PERSONAL STATEMENT

I am a CIMA fellow with 25 years of post-graduate business experience in diverse industries, countries and cultures. Since starting in finance my roles have been of increasing seniority, responsibility and complexity in both the private and public sector throughout which I have consistently demonstrated excellent communication and interpersonal skills. I am able to challenge and support the leadership and teams I work with and can explain complex financial items to non-finance stakeholders with ease. I regularly network within the education sector and ensure I am up to date with the latest guidance and information critical for running a finance function within the education sector.

KEY SKILLS

Management of finance teams; Financial & management accounting; statutory reporting including SORP 2019 & regulatory reporting including VAT returns; executive & senior management challenge and support; payroll management (in-house and bureau); pension scheme reporting; finance function management including AP & AR; treasury management; audit liaison and planning; internal control improvement; budget creation and control; team management and development; process improvement; income generation; risk management; project and change management; procurement; systems literacy including Oracle, PS Financials (IRIS), Access Finance, Coda, Parent Pay, SAP Concur, Cintra, EPM, SAGE Payroll; knowledge of MIS including SIMS & Bromcom.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Financial Controller, London Multi Academy Trust

November 2025 – July 2026

Since becoming a multi-academy trust in 2015 the Trust has grown to three secondary and six primary schools. My main duties include managing the finance business partners, business analyst and accounts team. I work with the CFO to improve strategic budget management with use of ICFP and benchmarking (annual and three-year revenue and capital budgets), financial reporting, and business partnering with the Head Teachers, and senior leaders to support informed decision-making and organisational objectives.

I manage my teams to ensure delivery of accurate monthly management accounts, KPIs, and cash-flow reporting, alongside ownership of the annual financial timetable and maintenance of robust financial controls and procedures. As part of this I have developed balance-sheet reconciliations and ensured strong internal control and segregation of duties across the Trust. Together the finance team provides financial guidance to Trust leadership which aligns academy-level financial management with Trust-wide goals.

I ensure the Trust achieves full compliance with regulatory and statutory requirements, including tax obligations, statutory returns, and adherence to the Academies Financial Handbook. I lead the external and internal audit processes, addressing recommendations and driving continuous improvement in financial governance and risk management.

**Multi Academy Trust, Project Accountant****May 2025 – November 2025**

During this fixed term contract I was able to produce significant improvements to consolidate balance sheet reporting for all of the trusts academies and central cost centres. In particular, following the difficult rollout of the Federation's new ERP system 2 years prior, I focused on correcting all of the payroll balance sheet transactions during which I reconciled historical Teachers' Pension payments following the Federation's switch to a single MAT payment and submission process. I also worked with the finance team members to develop a new process to correctly allocate pension journals and the monthly payments with a value of approximately £4m per month.

Multi Academy Trust, Interim Finance Director**March 2025 – May 2025**

I met with DfE representatives and a dedicated SRMA and managed a recovery plan whilst supporting the Trust with negotiating a financial advance. I assisted the trust whilst they worked through a staff re-organisation, by improving accounting processes and management reporting, by training governors on school finances and also providing challenge and support to the school overall. I managed a strict cash-flow regime due to extreme circumstances and identified better ways of managing the budget on an on-going basis.

Head of Finance & College Operations, Single Academy Trust**Jan 2022 – January 2025**

Secondary SAT & 6th form college with 960 pupils.

As the finance lead for the single academy trust I was responsible for financial management and statutory reporting for the single academy trust in line with UK accounting standards including FRS102, Charities SORP 2019, Companies Act 2006, academies accounts direction and the academy trust handbook. I also line managed all support functions including finance, procurement, human resources, in-house payroll & pensions, school administration, facilities including PFI, ICT, and outsourced catering. My main achievements are shown below:-

- As a positive team leader developing the skills and knowledge of my finance and payroll team was a priority. To this end I provided mentoring and training to my assistant business manager who was studying CIMA via an apprenticeship scheme and I gave her the support that had not been previously provided by the school.
- Working in multiple project teams concurrently I played a key role in founding a new multi-academy trust in 1st April 2024 which brought together 3 LA schools and our existing SAT.
- We successfully procured, designed, tested and implemented a new outsourced payroll bureau service for our combined 340 staff in time for go-live of the new MAT. I was personally responsible for the successful transfer of all teachers into the MAT TPS account ensuring timely access for the payroll provider and administrators.
- We simultaneously procured and implemented a new cloud-based finance system for the 4 schools and central trust which is designed for future growth and full automation of financial and DfE reporting.
- As part of managing financial strategy I worked closely with senior leadership in order to maintain the use of technology following COVID-19 whilst removing the financial risk from the academy. I also developed forward-looking lifecycle plans for equipment and negotiated with suppliers to provide affordable computer equipment to all pupils.
- Reviewing processes and introducing robust procedures I ensured best practice for internal controls and audit compliance. This included automating management reporting and improved liquidity reporting as well as tightening up cash controls and creating anti-fraud measures. I also corrected historical finance system errors that were apparent upon my arrival.
- Improving our in-house payroll processes and procedures including automating links with HMRC I ensured statutory compliance. This led to a successful outcome of an HMRC compliance check.
- I provided mentoring and training to my assistant business manager who was studying CIMA via an apprenticeship scheme and I gave her the support that was hitherto not provided.

**Senior Finance Manager, NHS Foundation Trust****January 2020 – January 2022**

I was responsible for the financial management of Children and Young People's Services Directorates which had combined expenditure budgets of £71m and external income budgets of £9m. My main duties and achievements are shown below:-

- Beginning this role at the start of the COVID-19 pandemic was a big challenge I was able to overcome by leading, supporting and developing a team of 3 Management Accountants whilst working remotely. As a result my team successfully provided highly complex strategic financial and business advice which supported the directorates to achieve their goals whilst adhering to the ever-evolving centrally-organised planning guidance.
- I managed a section 75 budget agreement (pooled fund between Local Authority and the NHS) and shared responsibility with my counterpart for reporting to the Joint Programme board.
- Through investigating historical data and agreements and meeting with multiple NHS bodies allowed me to recover £300k for the Trust in incorrect charges.
- Following a last-minute failure for a successor to be awarded the necessary approval to take-over one of our services I worked with the service director to create a £5m budget plan that ensured continued youth support by reorganising resources.

Finance Business Partner, Multi Academy Trust**December 2016 – December 2019**

I began here supporting 3 academies and then progressed to be responsible for 5 academies, working at 12 academies overall during my tenure here. My main duties and achievements are shown below:-

- Management of annual budgets with Executive Principals and reporting to schools' senior management and trustees. This included preparing management accounts and board packs for Federation meetings and presentations to the governors' finance committees.
- Achieved a successful audit outcome for a newly taken over school that ensured funds totaling £1m were successfully received despite the electronic financial records being destroyed in error.
- Improving academies' processes and procedures by training Finance Officers on financial accounting systems, procedures and policies and ensuring a standard practice for all.
- Guided an academy to its first surplus in three years through better monitoring and communication.
- Improved processes at an academy which ensured a satisfactory internal audit outcome.
- Obtained back-dated payments for SEND funding from Local Authorities for academies totaling c. £75k

Previous employment – Further details provided upon request**QUALIFICATIONS & TRAINING**

CIMA Fellow (FCMA)	Chartered Institute of Management Accountants	2025
ACMA & CGMA designations	Chartered Institute of Management Accountants	2015
BA (Hons) European Business Programme 2:1 / Diplôme de l'Ecole Multinationale des Affaires		2001
Diploma in Professional Development Skills		1999
4 A-Level Passes in Economics, English Law, French and Pure Mathematics		1997
11 GCSEs grade A* to C		1995



VOLUNTEERING & PAST TIMES

I am a Parent Governor for a primary school where my daughters attend. I have travelled extensively including a 3-month trip through Russia, Mongolia and China in 2006. Through my studies and foreign-based roles I am fluent in French and have previously learned Italian, Dutch, and Spanish.